



Key data analyst skill

Earlier, I told you that
you already have analytical skills.
You just might not know it yet.
When learning new things, sometimes
people overlook their own skills,
but it's important you take
the time to acknowledge them,
especially since these skills are going to help you
as a data analyst.
In fact, you're probably more prepared than you think.
Don't believe me?
Well, let me prove it.
Let's start by defining
what I'm talking about here.

Analytical skills are qualities and characteristics
associated with solving problems using facts.

There are a lot of aspects to analytical skills,
but, we'll focus on five essential points.
They are curiosity, understanding context,
having technical mindset, data design, and data strategy.

Now, you may be thinking,

"I don't have these kinds of skills,"

or "I only have a couple of them."

But stay with me, and I bet you'll change your mind.

Let's start with **curiosity**.

Curiosity is all about wanting to learn something.

Curious people usually seek out

new challenges and experiences.

This leads to knowledge.

The very fact that you're here with me right now

demonstrates that you have curiosity.

That was an easy one.

Now think about **understanding context**.

Context is the condition in

which something exists or happens.

This can be a structure or an environment.

A simple way of understanding context

is by counting to 5.

One, two, three, four, five.

All of those numbers exist in

the context of one through five.

But what if a friend of yours

said to you, one,

two, four, five, three?

Well, the three will be out of context.

Simple, right? But it can be a little tricky.

There's a good chance that you might not even notice

the three being out of context

if you aren't paying close attention.

That's why listening and trying

to understand the full picture is critical.

In your own life, you put

things into context all the time.

For example, let's think about your grocery list.

If you group together items like flour, sugar,

and yeast, that's you adding context to your groceries.

This saves you time

when you're at the baking aisle at the grocery store.

Let's look at another example.

Have you ever shuffled a deck of

cards and noticed the joker?

If you're playing a game that doesn't include jokers,

identifying that card means

you understand it's out of context.

Remove it, and you're much

more likely to play a successful game.

Now we know you have both curiosity

and the ability to understand context.

Let's move on to the third skill, a technical mindset.

A technical mindset involves the ability to

break things down into smaller steps or pieces

and work with them in an orderly and logical way.

For instance, when paying your bills,

you probably already break down

the process into smaller steps.

Maybe you start by sorting them

by the date they're due.

Next, you might add them up and

compare that amount to the balance in your bank account.

This would help you see if you can pay your bills now,

or if you should wait until the next paycheck.

Finally, you'd pay them.

When you take something that seems like a single task,

like paying your bills,

and break it into smaller steps

with an orderly process,

that's using a technical mindset.

Now let's explore the fourth part

of an analytical skill set,

data design. Data design is how you organize information.

As a data analyst, **design**

typically has to do with an actual database.

But, again,

the same skills can easily be applied to everyday life.

For example, think about

the way you organize the contacts in your phone.

That's actually a type of data design.

Maybe you list them by first name instead of last,

or maybe you use email addresses instead of their names.

What you're really doing is designing a clear, logical list that lets you call or text a contact in a quick and simple way.

The last, but definitely not least, the fifth and final element of analytical skills is **data strategy**.

Data strategy is the management of the people, processes, and tools used in data analysis.

Let's break that down.

You **manage people by making sure they know how to use the right data to find solutions to the problem you're working on.**

For **processes**, it's about making sure the path to that solution is clear and accessible.

For **tools**, you make sure the right technology is being used for the job.

Now, you may be doubting my ability to give you an example from real life that demonstrates data strategy.

But check this out. Imagine **mowing** a lawn.

Step 1 would be reading the owner's manual for the mower.

That's making sure the people involved, or you, in this example, know how to use the data available.

The manual would instruct you to put on protective eyewear and closed-toe shoes.

Then, it's on to step 2:

making the process, the path, clear and accessible.

This will involve you walking around the lawn,

picking up large sticks or

rocks that might get in your way.

Finally, for step 3,

you check the lawn mower, your tool,

to make sure it has enough gas and oil,

and is in working condition,

so the lawn can be mowed safely.

There you have it. Now you know

the five essential skills of a data analyst.

Curiosity, understanding context,

having a technical mindset,

data design, and data strategy.

I told you that you are already an analytical thinker.

Now, you can start actively practicing these skills

as you move through the rest of this course.

Curious about what's next?

Move on to the next video.

Explain this topic in simple terms

The material explains that to be a good data analyst, you already have some key skills without even realizing it! These are called analytical skills, and they're all about using facts to solve problems.

Think of it like baking a cake. You need ingredients like flour, sugar, and eggs, right? Analytical skills are the ingredients for solving problems as a data analyst! You already have these "ingredients" from your everyday life, like curiosity (wanting to learn the best cake recipe), understanding context (knowing when a recipe needs more sugar), and thinking in a structured way (following the recipe step-by-step).

Give me a summary

This video focuses on the five essential analytical skills needed to be a successful data analyst. These skills are:

- **Curiosity:** Always wanting to learn new things and seeking out new challenges.
- **Understanding Context:** The condition in which something exists or happens, like understanding the order of numbers or grouping similar items on a grocery list.
- **Technical Mindset:** Breaking down tasks into smaller, manageable steps. An example is the process of paying bills.
- **Data Design:** Organizing information in a clear and logical way, such as arranging contacts in your phone.
- **Data Strategy:** Managing people, processes, and tools in data analysis. An example is preparing to mow a lawn, from reading the manual to checking the mower.

The video emphasizes that you likely already use these skills in your daily life, which means you're more prepared to begin your data analyst journey than you might realize!

Give me real-life examples

You're right! It's helpful to see these skills in action. Let's take **data strategy**, for example.

Imagine you're planning a surprise birthday party for a friend. Here's how you might use data strategy without even realizing it:

- **People:** You gather information from your friend's close contacts about their preferences, any potential dietary restrictions, and their availability on certain dates. You're essentially managing "people" as sources of data.
- **Processes:** You create a checklist to ensure a smooth flow of the event. This might include sending invitations, organizing decorations, arranging the food, and planning activities. This is your process for achieving your goal.
- **Tools:** You might use online platforms for sending digital invitations, creating shared playlists for music, or managing RSVPs. These are the "tools" that aid in executing your plan.

Just like in data analysis, successfully planning a party involves managing people (your friend's circle), processes (the party planning steps), and tools (online platforms or physical resources).

Give me practice questions

1. **True/False:** Analytical skills are only useful in fields like data analysis and are not applicable to everyday life.
2. **Multiple Choice:** Which of the following is NOT an example of using a "technical mindset"?
 - Following a recipe step-by-step to bake a cake.
 - Sorting laundry into different piles based on color and fabric type.
 - Daydreaming about a future vacation.
 - Assembling furniture by following instructions in a manual.
3. **Open-Ended:** Describe a time when you used "context" to understand a situation better. This could be anything from a conversation to a news story.
4. **Open-Ended:** How is organizing your digital music library an example of "data design"? What factors might you consider when designing it?
5. **True/False:** "Data strategy" is a passive process where you simply collect data without a clear purpose or plan.